

The Necklace

Guy de Maupassant · 1884

First published: Le Gaulois, Feb 1884 (tr. Jonathan Sturges, 1889, in The Odd Number, Harper)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Stories_by_Foreign_Authors_(French_I)/The_Necklace (revision 13522838), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Necklace suggest about vanity and appearance?
- What does The Necklace suggest about class?
- What does The Necklace suggest about honesty?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Necklace	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*vanity and appearance* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Necklace

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Guy de Maupassant's life or times connects to vanity and appearance in “The Necklace”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (vanity and appearance, class, honesty).

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2

Author biography

Guy de Maupassant was born in Normandy, France, on 5 August 1850. After serving in the Franco-Prussian War he worked as a government clerk in Paris and was mentored by the storyist Gustave Flaubert, a friend of his mother's. His story "Boule de Suif" (1880) made his name, and in about a decade he published some 300 stories and six stories, known for their precise realism and irony. He suffered from syphilis, which affected his mind; after a suicide attempt he was confined to an asylum and died in Paris on 6 July 1893.

Historical and cultural context

Paris in the 1880s was a society of rigid class distinctions; minor civil servants like Monsieur Loisel lived on small salaries, and social events such as a ministry ball were chances to display status.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published as "La Parure" in the newspaper Le Gaulois on 17 February 1884.

Then: Very popular in France and soon translated.

Now: One of the most famous twist endings, widely taught on irony, materialism and class.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from a rich friend for a ball, and loses it.

Main themes

- appearance versus reality.
- pride and vanity.
- class.

Why it matters

The story questions consumer culture and the cost of pretending.

Spoilers · teacher only

The Loisels borrow heavily to replace it and spend ten years in poverty paying the debt; then Mathilde learns the original was fake.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Necklace: Have you ever pretended to be something you're not?
Prompt: Before we open The Necklace: Have you ever pretended to be something you're not?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
situational irony; twist ending; characterization; foil.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Guy de Maupassant was born in Normandy, France, on 5 August 1850. After serving in the Franco-Prussian War he worked as a government clerk in Paris and was mentored by the storyist Gustave Flaubert, a friend of his mother's. His story "Boule de Suif" (1880) made his name, and in about a decade he published some 300 stories and six stories, known for their precise realism and irony. He suffered from syphilis, which affected his mind; after a suicide attempt he was confined to an asylum and died in Paris on 6 July 1893. The world of the book. Paris in the 1880s was a society of rigid class distinctions; minor civil servants like Monsieur Loisel lived on small salaries, and social events such as a ministry ball were chances to display status. Publication and reception. First published as "La Parure" in the newspaper Le Gaulois on 17 February 1884. Then: Very popular in France and soon translated. Now: One of the most famous twist endings, widely taught on irony, materialism and class.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries" slowly and put it in my own words: Her discontent. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence moves in one steady line, which makes the statement sound settled and sure. The word "ceaselessly" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. What does this suggest about life beyond the story? My answer: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from a rich friend for a ball, and loses it.

> *She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries* (The Necklace, paragraph 5)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries" slowly and put it in my own words: Her discontent. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence moves in one steady line, which makes the statement sound settled and sure. The word "ceaselessly" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. What does this suggest about life beyond the story? My answer: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from a rich friend for a ball, and loses it.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from a rich friend for a ball, and loses it. Themes to track: appearance versus reality.: pride and vanity.: class.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Example page. Theme: appearance versus reality. Prediction: I expect this idea to be tested when a character has to choose between what they want and what others expect. Question: what will The Necklace suggest about appearance versus reality by the end?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Necklace: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Example page. Theme: appearance versus reality. Prediction: I expect this idea to be tested when a character has to choose between what they want and what others expect. Question: what will The Necklace suggest about appearance versus reality by the end?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Necklace still matter? The story questions consumer culture and the cost of pretending.
Anchor question: Why might The Necklace still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story questions consumer culture and the cost of pretending.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
What lesson might Mathilde learn? Answer: Honesty would have saved her ten years; appearances deceive; she gains strength through work.
Exit ticket: What lesson might Mathilde learn?
Answer: Honesty would have saved her ten years; appearances deceive; she gains strength through work.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Necklace.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Guy de Maupassant" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Guy-de-Maupassant); Guy de Maupassant, Complete Short Stories (translations) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The in-app text is the Jonathan Sturges translation (Harper, 1889) and opens without the famous first paragraph found in other translations. The edition label matches (tr. Jonathan Sturges, 1889).

Lesson 2: The Necklace

Focus: the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "The Necklace" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…remarked by the minister himself. She danced with intoxication, with passion, made drunk by pleasure,…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets Madame Forestier and tells her the truth. The original was paste, worth at most five hundred francs.

Background: Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US.

Significance: One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance versus reality because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance versus reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: everyone is fooled by appearances.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bracelets — bands or chains worn around the wrist; vestibule — an entrance hall; humiliating — making one feel ashamed and foolish; homeward — oriented toward home; triumphant — joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success. "humiliating": Origin of "humiliate": Late Latin humiliātus; earlier Latin humilis ("lowly"). "triumphant": Origin: Latin triumphāns.
Words: bracelets: bands or chains worn around the wrist · vestibule: an entrance hall · humiliating: making one feel ashamed and foolish · homeward: oriented toward home · triumphant: joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US. One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans. Irony: The fake necklace costs ten real years. Characterization: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal. Foil: Madame Forestier's wealth highlights Mathilde's discontent. Watch for the necklace: false value.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries" slowly and put it in my own words: Character. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence moves in one steady line, which makes the statement sound settled and sure. The word "ceaselessly" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. Where is the gap between what is said and what is true? My answer: The fake necklace costs ten real years.

> *She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries (The Necklace, paragraph 5)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries" slowly and put it in my own words: Character. Next, craft. I notice that the sentence moves in one steady line, which makes the statement sound settled and sure. The word "ceaselessly" is the strongest in the line; it sharpens the picture more than a plainer word would. Then, effect. Where is the gap between what is said and what is true? My answer: The fake necklace costs ten real years.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The reveal. Look at the craft: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance versus reality? Expected: Everyone is fooled by appearances. (The reveal.)

> *Why, my necklace was paste (The Necklace, paragraph 130)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The reveal. Look at the craft: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance versus reality?
Expected answer: Everyone is fooled by appearances. (The reveal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Necklace develops the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.) Exemplar: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. When the text says “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108), it shows this directly. She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."
Task: Annotate the story for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Necklace develops the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.)
Exemplar: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. When the text says “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108), it shows this directly. She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are? Ask: is Mathilde a better person at the end?
Anchor question: Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?
Facilitation: Ask: is Mathilde a better person at the end?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. ("How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved", The Necklace, paragraph 108). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. ("How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved", The Necklace, paragraph 108). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Key takeaway: everyone is fooled by appearances.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The fake necklace costs ten real years.
- **Characterization:** Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal.
- **Foil:** Madame Forestier's wealth highlights Mathilde's discontent.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance versus reality:** everyone is fooled by appearances.

Symbols and motifs

- **the necklace:** false value.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries" (The Necklace, paragraph 5) Character.
- "Why, my necklace was paste" (The Necklace, paragraph 130) The reveal.
- "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved" (The Necklace, paragraph 108) The narrator's reflection.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her.
Evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108)
Reasoning: She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bracelets (noun)	bands or chains worn around the wrist	*She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.*	
vestibule (noun)	an entrance hall	*"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."*	
humiliating (adjective)	making one feel ashamed and foolish	*"No; there's nothing more humiliating than to look poor among other women who are rich."*	“humiliating”: Origin of “humiliate”: Late Latin humiliātus; earlier Latin humilis (“lowly”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/humiliate#Etymology)
homeward (adjective)	oriented toward home	*It took them to their door in the Rue des Martyrs, and once more, sadly, they climbed up homeward.*	
triumphant (adjective)	joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success	*But, one evening, her husband returned home with a triumphant air, and holding a large envelope in his hand.*	“triumphant”: Origin: Latin triumphāns. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/triumphant#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with vanity and appearance?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is Mathilde's husband's job? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction
2. Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To look rich at a ball
3. How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ten years
4. What happens to Mathilde's appearance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She becomes worn and coarse from hard work
5. What does Madame Forestier reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The original necklace was fake
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Necklace” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets Madame Forestier and tells her the truth. The original was paste, worth at most five hundred francs.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Necklace”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Necklace” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.” What does “bracelets” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bracelets: bands or chains worn around the wrist.
10. Reread: “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."” What does “vestibule” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: vestibule: an entrance hall.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Necklace” suggest about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the characterization in this story shape what we understand about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5): Character. On characterization: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working;

Loisel is loyal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, why might Maupassant have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Necklace”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Mathilde Loisel, a clerk's wife who dreams of luxury, borrows a diamond necklace from her rich friend Madame Forestier for a ministry ball. She loses it, and the Loisels secretly buy a replacement for 36,000 francs, sinking into poverty for ten years to repay the debt. Worn and aged, Mathilde meets…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Necklace” set up that the rest of The Necklace will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130): The reveal. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108): The narrator's reflection. On characterization: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people sometimes pretend to be more than they are?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with vanity and appearance? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5): Character. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in Le Gaulois in 1884. Translation: Jonathan Sturges, in The Odd Number (1889), public domain in the US. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130): The reveal. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “One of the best-known twist endings; on Glencoe grade 9 lesson plans.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108): The narrator's reflection. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5): Character. On characterization: Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Necklace” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130): The reveal. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Necklace”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108): The narrator's reflection. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to class: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Maupassant need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5): Character. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130): The reveal. On irony: The fake

necklace costs ten real years. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “The Necklace” treats the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Necklace see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108): The narrator's reflection. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve vanity and appearance? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5): Character. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130): The reveal. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Guy de Maupassant about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Useful evidence: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108): The narrator's reflection. Theme link: everyone is fooled by appearances. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt?
   A. Ten years
   B. One year
   C. Thirty years

D. Six months

Key: A (Ten years)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Necklace, paragraph 108: “How _____ a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved”

   Key: little

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Mathilde's husband's job?

   A. A banker

   B. A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction

   C. A shopkeeper

   D. A soldier

   Key: B (A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Mathilde's appearance?

   A. She becomes worn and coarse from hard work

   B. She becomes rich

   C. She becomes more beautiful

   D. She stays the same

   Key: A (She becomes worn and coarse from hard work)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace?

   A. To look rich at a ball

   B. As a gift

   C. To sell it

   D. To copy it

   Key: A (To look rich at a ball)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But, one evening, her husband returned home with a _____ air, and holding a large envelope in his hand.” Word bank: vestibule, triumphant, bracelets, humiliating

   Key: triumphant

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Madame Forestier reveal?

   A. She wants it back

   B. The original necklace was fake

   C. She knew all along

   D. She found the necklace

   Key: B (The original necklace was fake)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Necklace, paragraph 5: “She suffered _____, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries”

   Key: ceaselessly

9. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Necklace”?

   A. Love measured by sacrifice

   B. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

   C. Revenge carried out with perfect control

D. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

Key: D (The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Character.
11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The reveal.
12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Necklace”? The fake necklace costs ten real years.
    A. Plot
    B. Irony
    C. Setting
    D. Structure

    Key: B (Irony)
13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Necklace”? Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal.
    A. Theme
    B. Diction / vocabulary
    C. Characterization
    D. Structure

    Key: C (Characterization)
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108).
    Sample answer: She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The narrator's reflection.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Character.
17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how appearance versus reality develops from an earlier story to “The Necklace”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: everyone is fooled by appearances.
18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The reveal.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “"No; there's nothing more humiliating than to look poor among other women who are rich."”, what does “humiliating” most nearly mean?

    A. oriented toward home

    B. an entrance hall

    C. making one feel ashamed and foolish

    D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

    Key: C (making one feel ashamed and foolish)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."”, what does “vestibule” most nearly mean?

    A. bands or chains worn around the wrist

    B. oriented toward home

    C. making one feel ashamed and foolish

    D. an entrance hall

    Key: D (an entrance hall)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, what does “bracelets” most nearly mean?

    A. making one feel ashamed and foolish

    B. bands or chains worn around the wrist

    C. oriented toward home

    D. an entrance hall

    Key: B (bands or chains worn around the wrist)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It took them to their door in the Rue des Martyrs, and once more, sadly, they climbed up homeward.”, what does “homeward” most nearly mean?

    A. an entrance hall

    B. making one feel ashamed and foolish

    C. oriented toward home

    D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

    Key: C (oriented toward home)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 4, 2, 5, 8, 1, 7, 3, 11, 10, 9, 15, 13, 12, 14, 17	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 1, 6, 8, 4, 2, 3, 5, 11, 9, 10, 14, 12, 15, 18, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 1, 4, 5, 7, 2, 3, 10, 9, 11, 13, 15, 14, 12, 18, 17	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 2, 1, 6, 3, 8, 10, 9, 11, 15, 14, 12, 13, 17, 16, 19	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3

AP	7, 8, 2, 20, 21, 10, 11, 9, 15, 14, 13, 12, 16, 19, 17, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 1, 8, 22, 6, 9, 10, 11, 13, 12, 15, 14, 19, 17, 16, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 6, 22, 21, 20, 10, 11, 9, 14, 15, 12, 13, 16, 18, 19, 17	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 6, 23, 21, 22, 9, 11, 10, 12, 15, 13, 14, 18, 19, 16, 17	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	4, 20, 21, 2, 6, 10, 11, 9, 12, 13, 14, 15, 18, 19, 16, 17	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 8, 1, 21, 20, 10, 9, 11, 14, 12, 13, 15, 16, 17, 19, 18	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Necklace,” how does Maupassant show the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In The Necklace, how does Maupassant develop the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Necklace develops the idea of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. Read in the public-domain translation by Jonathan Sturges.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of The Necklace (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what The Necklace suggests about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Guy de Maupassant uses irony in The Necklace to complicate the reader's understanding of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Necklace within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Necklace alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Necklace and its treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Necklace as evidence for a larger claim about the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are in The Necklace. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Necklace as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of the cost of wanting to seem richer than you are. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Necklace.

SAT-style questions

1. *She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “bracelets” most nearly mean?

   A. oriented toward home

   B. joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success

   C. bands or chains worn around the wrist

   D. making one feel ashamed and foolish

2. *She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship. She tried on the ornaments before the glass, hesitated, could not make up her mind to part with them, to give them back. She kept asking:*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Necklace”?

   A. Revenge carried out with perfect control

   B. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

   C. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

   D. A story told to protect a livelihood

SAT key: 1. C (bands or chains worn around the wrist); 2. B (The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are)

Unit test

The Necklace: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Necklace, paragraph 108: “How _____ a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved”

   Key: little

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But, one evening, her husband returned home with a _____ air, and holding a large envelope in his hand.” Word bank: vestibule, triumphant, bracelets, humiliating

   Key: triumphant

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Mathilde borrow the necklace?

   A. To look rich at a ball
   B. As a gift
   C. To sell it
   D. To copy it

   Key: A (To look rich at a ball)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Mathilde's husband's job?

   A. A banker
   B. A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction
   C. A shopkeeper
   D. A soldier

   Key: B (A clerk in the Ministry of Public Instruction)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Madame Forestier reveal?

   A. She wants it back
   B. The original necklace was fake
   C. She knew all along
   D. She found the necklace

   Key: B (The original necklace was fake)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long do the Loisels work to repay the debt?

   A. Ten years

   B. One year

   C. Thirty years

   D. Six months

   Key: A (Ten years)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Necklace, paragraph 5: “She suffered _____, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries”

   Key: ceaselessly

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Mathilde's appearance?

   A. She becomes worn and coarse from hard work

   B. She becomes rich

   C. She becomes more beautiful

   D. She stays the same

   Key: A (She becomes worn and coarse from hard work)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

   Sample answer: Character.

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Necklace”?

    A. Love measured by sacrifice

    B. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

    C. Revenge carried out with perfect control

    D. The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are

    Key: D (The cost of wanting to seem richer than you are)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The reveal.

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Necklace”? The fake necklace costs ten real years.

    A. Plot

    B. Irony

    C. Setting

    D. Structure

    Key: B (Irony)

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108).

    Sample answer: She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved” (The Necklace, paragraph 108). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The narrator's reflection.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “The Necklace”? Mathilde changes from vain to hard-working; Loisel is loyal.
    A. Theme
    B. Diction / vocabulary
    C. Characterization
    D. Structure

    Key: C (Characterization)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Why, my necklace was paste” (The Necklace, paragraph 130) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The reveal.
17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Mathilde's pride, not bad luck, ruins her.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She hides the loss instead of confessing, and only later learns "my necklace was paste"; the narrator reflects "How little a thing is needed for us to be lost or to be saved."
18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She suffered ceaselessly, feeling herself born for all the delicacies and all the luxuries” (The Necklace, paragraph 5) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Character.
19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how appearance versus reality develops from an earlier story to “The Necklace”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: everyone is fooled by appearances.
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “"Yes, I felt it in the vestibule of the palace."”, what does “vestibule” most nearly mean?
    A. bands or chains worn around the wrist
    B. oriented toward home
    C. making one feel ashamed and foolish
    D. an entrance hall

    Key: D (an entrance hall)
21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “"No; there's nothing more humiliating than to look poor among other women who are rich."”, what does “humiliating” most nearly mean?
    A. oriented toward home
    B. an entrance hall
    C. making one feel ashamed and foolish
    D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

    Key: C (making one feel ashamed and foolish)
22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She saw first of all some bracelets, then a pearl necklace, then a Venetian cross, gold, and precious stones of admirable workmanship.”, what does “bracelets” most nearly mean?
    A. making one feel ashamed and foolish

B. bands or chains worn around the wrist

C. oriented toward home

D. an entrance hall

Key: B (bands or chains worn around the wrist)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It took them to their door in the Rue des Martyrs, and once more, sadly, they climbed up homeward.”, what does “homeward” most nearly mean?

A. an entrance hall

B. making one feel ashamed and foolish

C. oriented toward home

D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

Key: C (oriented toward home)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	5, 4, 3, 1, 8, 7, 6, 2, 10, 9, 11, 12, 13, 15, 14, 18, 19, 17	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	7, 4, 2, 8, 5, 6, 1, 3, 10, 11, 9, 14, 15, 12, 13, 17, 16, 18	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Junior	4, 7, 2, 5, 8, 6, 1, 3, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 14, 17, 18, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
HS Senior	4, 3, 1, 5, 2, 6, 8, 7, 11, 10, 9, 15, 14, 12, 13, 19, 18, 17	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 3, 21, 2, 7, 4, 5, 10, 9, 11, 15, 13, 14, 12, 17, 18, 16, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 7, 4, 2, 5, 8, 1, 9, 10, 11, 13, 15, 12, 14, 18, 16, 17, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 8, 5, 22, 20, 3, 1, 10, 9, 11, 13, 15, 14, 12, 19, 16, 17, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 4, 23, 5, 7, 1, 8, 9, 11, 10, 15, 12, 14, 13, 18, 17, 16, 19	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	7, 6, 4, 21, 2, 23, 3, 11, 9, 10, 15, 13, 12, 14, 19, 16, 17, 18	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 20, 1, 9, 11, 10, 14, 12, 13, 15, 17, 18, 19, 16	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

The Necklace: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Guy de Maupassant develops vanity and appearance across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Necklace and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to class.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Necklace. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Necklace finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of honesty. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Vanity and appearance

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about vanity and appearance. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops vanity and appearance across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of vanity and appearance. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of vanity and appearance, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of vanity and appearance in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on vanity and appearance in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on vanity and appearance in The Necklace. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about vanity and appearance in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on vanity and appearance in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Class

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about class. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops class in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops class across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of class in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class in The Necklace. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Honesty

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Necklace teaches about honesty. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Guy de Maupassant develops honesty in The Necklace. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Guy de Maupassant develops honesty across The Necklace. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Necklace (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of honesty. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of honesty in The Necklace. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Guy de Maupassant's choices in The Necklace (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of honesty, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Necklace's treatment of honesty in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on honesty in The Necklace that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on honesty in The Necklace. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about honesty in The Necklace, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on honesty in The Necklace, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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